

Xizhu Hou

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 <https://houxizhu.github.io/devops/>

Career Summary

Experienced DevOps Engineer with proven expertise in infrastructure automation, configuration management, CI/CD pipelines, and cloud-native architectures. Adept at managing large-scale environments and delivering scalable and reliable infrastructure.

Technical Skills

- Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, CloudFormation)
- Configuration Management (Ansible/Puppet/SaltStack)
- CI/CD pipelines (GitHub/GitLab/GoCD/Bitbucket)
- Cloud Platforms (AWS, GCP)
- Containerization & Orchestration (Docker, Kubernetes/EKS)
- Monitoring & Logging (Grafana, New Relic, Zabbix)
- Linux Administration (Amazon Linux, Red Hat, CentOS)
- Scripting & Automation: Python, Bash

Professional Experience

Dec 2025 – present

DevOps Engineer

Ramsay Health Care (contract)

RHC runs large-scale healthcare IT platforms using cloud, enterprise infrastructure, data platforms and automation to support hospitals, analytics, and digital clinical systems.

Key Responsibilities

- Design, provision, and manage cloud infrastructure on AWS and GCP using Terraform.
- Operate and maintain Kubernetes clusters, including deployments and secrets management.
- Build and maintain CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions to automate build, test, and deployment workflows.
- Support cloud-native application deployments using containers and Kubernetes best practices.
- Manage environment configuration, access controls, and secrets following security and compliance standards.
- Collaborate with development teams to improve deployment processes and platform reliability.
- Monitor system health, performance, and availability, responding to incidents and operational issues.

Contributions

- Improved infrastructure consistency and reduced manual errors by adopting Terraform across cloud environments.
- Accelerated release cycles by implementing automated CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions.
- Enhanced platform scalability and reliability through optimized Kubernetes configurations and deployment strategies.
- Increased operational stability by standardizing deployment workflows across development, staging, and production environments.
- Strengthened system resilience through proactive monitoring, troubleshooting, and continuous improvement.
- Contributed to documentation, runbooks, and operational standards to support team onboarding and knowledge sharing.

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DevOps Engineer (May 2022 – Oct 2024)

IriusRisk

Threat modeling platform automating and supporting secure design at scale.

Contributions

- **Large-Scale Infrastructure Management**
Automated configuration using Ansible ensuring consistency, reduced downtime, and improved reliability across production and staging environments.
- **Cloud Infrastructure Modernization**
Led the migration from AWS CloudFormation to Terraform, improving maintainability and flexibility of infrastructure code, enabling better collaboration.
- **Monitoring & Observability Automation**
Standardized monitoring across cloud environments by automating New Relic and Grafana. Enabled consistent alerting and integration with application services.
- **EKS Proof of Concept & Cloud-Native Initiatives**
Delivered PoC Amazon EKS to support containerized applications, streamlining orchestration and enabling migration to Kubernetes-based microservices.
- **CI/CD Integration & Delivery Automation**
Integrated infrastructure provisioning and configuration into CI/CD pipelines. Accelerated deployment cycles and improved delivery confidence.

Linux Specialist (Sep 2021 – Apr 2022)

Australian Post (contract)

Contributions

- Leveraged Ansible for configuration management, automating deployment processes and maintaining consistency across a large-scale RedHat environment.
- Administered Red Hat Linux and midrange platforms, focusing on system performance, security hardening, and user management.

Site Reliability Engineer (Apr 2021 – Sep 2021)

Compass Education (contract)

Compass education provides a web-based school management system connecting every facet of 2000+ schools to simplify the complex.

Contributions

- **Ansible** – On-premise deployment project, tools containerized
- **Kubernetes** – Administration of 4 k8s clusters including prod/staging
- **Monitoring** - Day to day monitoring of Zabbix, Grafana, Opsgenie and Prometheus

System Admin (Aug 2016 – Apr 2021)

DoubleIQ

DoubleIQ offers data analysis, business services and solutions.

Contributions

- Managing and upgrading 100+ CentOS VM
- Install/setup/configure tool servers - Zabbix, PostgreSQL, GitLab etc.

Qualifications

- CKA - Certified Kubernetes Administrator
- AWS - Certified DevOps Professional
- CCNP - Cisco Certified Network Professional

Education

- Master Degree, Computer Science, BUPT

Referees

Referees available upon request.